Captain's Guide

companion page for the Delivery Day Log

The log is for the family more than for you, and that's on purpose. Set it up once on the counter with a pen, and every future question — "who do we thank?" "when did that chicken go in the freezer?" "did we eat Aunt D's casserole or is it still in there?" — has a one-line answer.

Make it zero-effort for tired people

— Tape it to the fridge or prop it next to the cooler. Visible beats organized; a log in a drawer is a rumor.

— Tell volunteers they can fill their own row and take three seconds to do it. People like finishing their favor on paper.

— Nobody has to keep this pretty. Half the rows can be "soup.", check, check, check. It still works perfectly.

Why the little columns matter

— Allergen-flag column: tires people forget midweek which friend has which allergy. The paper remembers.

— Cooler column: confirms the drop-off actually completed when nobody answered the door.

— Eat now / freeze column: this is how a freezer full of generosity never turns into a freezer full of mystery.

Gentle gotchas

— Dates on everything. "Fresh" and "cooked last Tuesday" are different facts, and the log is where they get separated.

— Food safety, said plainly: cold stays cold, hot gets refrigerated, porch-sitting has a shelf life, and tossing a doubtful dish is not ungrateful — it's the expected move.

Sixty seconds of scribbling per meal buys the family a clean accounting of kindness — and, later, the exact list of people to thank without a single "I think her name was…?" moment.